

ANALYSIS OF CONSUMER PREFERENCES IN SUSTAINABLE FASHION CONSUMPTION

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Purpose. Growing consumer concern about the environmental and ethical impact of their clothing purchases has led to an increased desire for more conscious alternatives, which has stimulated the emergence of a market for products that prioritise sustainability. This study aims to explore the complexities of consumer preferences and choices in sustainable fashion consumption by uncovering the key factors that guide consumers in selecting clothing items through choice-based conjoint analysis. To analyse the consumers' preferences, seven attributes and attribute levels are determined firstly and then the data for the study are collected by designing a survey through the Conjointly online platform.

Results. Price emerges as the most significant factor, indicating the substantial influence of economic considerations on sustainable clothing consumption choices. Following price, the choice of product material ranks second, reflecting the importance consumers place on material quality and the environmental impact of these materials. Ethical production practices, ranking as the third most important attribute, emphasise the critical role of ethical labor conditions in shaping the decision-making process of consumers. Brand reputation ranks among the third less pivotal considerations, while sustainability certificates do not hold the same decisive power as price, product material, and ethical production practices. Supply chain transparency is the least influential attribute while geographical production location demonstrates a comparatively limited influence on consumer choices.

Scientific novelty. This research is motivated by the growing focus on sustainability in the fashion industry and the need to bridge the gap between consumer preferences and sustainable clothing alternatives. The novelty of this research is provide insights into the factors that influence consumers on choosing sustainable clothing by quantifying the comparative significance of the preferences of customers.

Practical value. This study aspires to contribute a fresh perspective and valuable insights to the field of sustainable fashion. Furthermore, it intends to offer practical recommendations for brands and policymakers as they navigate this ever-evolving landscape. Recognising the determinants of consumers' intentions to purchase sustainable garments is imperative for fashion brands and policymakers striving to promote sustainable practices and tailor their product offerings to match consumers' preferences.

Key words: sustainability, consumer preferences, sustainable clothing, choice-based conjoint analysis.

Introduction. In a world where ecological and ethical considerations have gained increasing awareness, there is an awakening to the importance of sustainable choices. This shift, particularly evident in the fashion industry, has led to a transformation in the way people approach their clothing purchases with consumers driving significant changes in purchasing behavior. It has sparked a request for more sustainable options, fostering a thriving market for eco-conscious products. This shift in consumer behavior is not only reshaping the market but also compelling fashion brands to re-evaluate their production practices and product offerings to better align with these evolving preferences. The growing concern that consumers have about the ecological and ethical impact of their clothing purchases has led to a heightened desire for more conscious alternatives. This, in turn, has created a market for products that prioritise sustainability.

This study aims to explore the complexities of consumer preferences and choices in sustainable fashion consumption by uncovering the key factors that guide consumers in selecting clothing items. The ultimate objective is to quantify the comparative significance of attributes and provide insights into the factors that influence consumers when it comes to choosing sustainable clothing. The investigation into how consumers balance their desires for sustainable products with other factors, and to what extent they are willing to adjust their choices to prioritise sustainability, constitutes the central focus of this study.

Therefore, the primary objective of this empirical study is to illuminate consumers' preferences and choices in sustainable fashion consumption through the application of Choice-Based Conjoint (CBC) analysis. Beyond solely considering the environmental impact, consumers take into account a range of attributes that inform their clothing choices. The initial goal of this study is to quantify the relative importance of these clothing attributes. Thus, the overarching three research questions guiding this study are as follows: i) What are the determining attributes of consumers' clothing preferences? ii) How do consumers prioritise sustainability factors relative to other attributes? iii) Do consumers' sociodemographic profiles influence pro-sustainable behavior in purchasing clothing? The study also seeks to establish connections between consumer characteristics and their engagement in environmentally friendly consumption, recognising that individuals' sociodemographic traits may influence their environmental consciousness.

Review of literature. A diverse range of research was conducted on consumer preferences and sustainable choices. Anderson et al. (2004) conducted a study, centered on a sample of Oregon State University students that showed that environmental certification positively influenced wood furniture preferences for most respondents. Kojcic & Kuzmanovic (2022) analysed the factors that influence green consumer purchasing for an electronic device by using choice-based conjoint analysis and found that technical performances are the most important features, while environmental characteristics, price, and warranty period are rather important, but not crucial when purchasing electronic equipment. Chowdhury et al. (2011) examined the preferences

of Swedish green car consumers by applying adaptive choice-based conjoint analysis. Meanwhile, Falkner et al. (2017) conducted a conjoint analysis to explore how Chinese consumers perceive green product attributes.

Verma et al. (2018) investigated the contributions of sustainability in consumers' hotel choice decision by applying choice-based conjoint analysis using both qualitative (word association test) and quantitative (orthogonal choice design survey) data from hotel customers. In a study by Chekima et al. (2016), the objective was to identify the motivating factors affecting the intention to make environmentally friendly purchases while considering the potential moderating influences of premium pricing and demographics.

Jacobs (2020) investigated the determinants of sustainable purchase behavior of customers by concentrating on four quantitative empirical studies to address the major research gaps in the field of sustainable consumption. Sanad (2016) conducted informative research on the factors affecting the purchasers' decision towards apparel and textile products by reviewing research studies in this area. His findings concluded that market-dominated variables such as product characteristics, purchase channel, price, and promotion alongside consumer-dominated factors including different cultural, social, personal, psychological, and environmental aspects are shaping the consumers' minds.

Materials and methods. The objective of preference measurement is to determine the extent to which consumers favour or attribute value, ultimately deriving utility from particular products, a factor that plays a pivotal role in their purchasing decisions. Conjoint analysis, among the widely adopted techniques in preference measurement, posits that products can be regarded as bundles of attributes (Eggers et al., 2021). As a multivariate analytical method, it investigates consumer perspectives and factors influencing pre-purchase considerations (Kulshreshtha et al., 2018).

The technique is built on the assumption that complex decisions are shaped by multiple factors considered jointly, rather than a single criterion. It assumes that consumers evaluate the value of a product or service by combining the individual contributions of each attribute (Kuzmanovic et al., 2013). Involving attribute decomposition, preference ranking by respondents, and the use of statistically designed product combinations for evaluation, it is instrumental in comprehending consumer desires and optimising product or service offerings to encourage purchases (Kulshreshtha et al., 2018).

The initial stage in performing a conjoint analysis involves the classification of attributes, which identifies the key factors influencing customer choices, and specifies the different values for each key factor, referred to as attribute levels (Zhou & Xu, 2019). It is crucial to assign levels that are realistic, actionable, and open to trade-offs. Additionally, incorporating what is commonly referred to as a "no-choice option" (also known as a "none option" or "outside good") enhances the authenticity of CBC, as it provides an alternative that can be selected if none of the presented choices are deemed acceptable (Eggers et al., 2021). To determine the significance of different attributes,

it is essential to establish a functional relationship between these attributes and the resulting utility. To construct the CBC experiment, the primary step is to determine the attributes that are related to the research questions and subsequently define the different levels for each of these attributes. It is essential to select attributes that influence consumers' utility to ensure the study includes the most relevant and influential factors in shaping their preferences.

To determine the significance of different attributes, it is essential to establish a functional relationship between these attributes and the resulting utility. The widely employed and straightforward model for this purpose is the linear additive model. This model suggests that the total utility or valuation derived from a specific set of attributes within a particular product or service is determined by adding up the individual utilities associated with each attribute (van der Pol & Ryan, 1996). Consumers assess the total utility of a product by aggregating individual utilities, which indicate the attractiveness of specific attribute levels (Kojcic & Kuzmanovic, 2022). The model operates under the assumption that products can be deconstructed into specific attribute levels (Krystallis et al., 2005). It is a decompositional methodology, wherein it solicits consumers' comprehensive preference for experimentally altered product concepts and subsequently breaks down the overall utility into attribute-specific utilities, commonly known as "partworth utilities", using statistical procedures (Eggers et al., 2021). The partworth function determines the value consumers associate with various levels of each attribute, representing the extent to which an attribute level influences the consumer's preference. A positive value enhances consumer preference, while a negative value diminishes it (Velcovska et al., 2021).

The seven attributes associated with the purpose of this study and the rationale for their inclusion are as follows: a) Brand Reputation: Not only rational factors such as functionality and price but also brand loyalty have a possible influence on clothing choices (Park-Poaps et al., 2018); b) Product Material: Examining the material of the product in terms of its impact on the environment helps understand clothing choices (Sigaard et al., 2023); c) Ethical Production: While many consumers prioritise products produced without harm to workers, individuals juggling multiple considerations during a purchase might overlook this ethical dimension; d) Sustainability Certifications: There are numerous sustainability certifications relevant to the clothing and textile industry (Gavranovic, 2020); e) Production Location: The distance between where the product is produced and delivered to consumers and the issue of exploitation of labor and potential risks to the health and well-being of workers in low-cost labor markets abroad have emerged as significant concerns among consumers; f) Supply Chain Transparency: With increased awareness of the ethics behind the labor conditions, consumers could favor the disclosure of more information about how a product is made, sourced, and distributed (Mukherjee, 2015); g) Price: Incorporating price as an attribute mirrors real-life decision scenarios, increasing the results' relevance and accurately reflecting consumer behavior due to its role in every purchase.

The summary of seven attributes and attribute levels chosen in the study to explore

the consumers' preferences and choices in sustainable fashion consumption is presented at Table 1.

Table 1

Summary of attributes and attribute levels

Attributes	Attribute levels
Brand reputation	1. Established eco-friendly brand; 2. Emerging sustainable brand; 3. Strong mass-market reputation.
Product material	1. Sustainable material (i.e. organic cotton, recycled cotton, linen, recycled polyester); 2. Non-sustainable materials (i.e. nylon, conventional cotton, other conventional materials).
Ethical production	1. Fair wages & safe working conditions; 2. No ethical production considerations.
Sustainability certifications	1. No sustainability certificate available; 2. Limited sustainability certification (some products may have certifications, while others do not); 3. Moderate sustainability certification (a significant portion of products have certifications); 4. Extensive sustainability certification (almost all or all products have certifications).
Production location	1. Germany; 2. Europe; 3. Overseas.
Supply chain transparency	1. No supply chain information available; 2. Limited supply chain information available; 3. Detailed supply chain information available.
Price	1. EUR 5.99; 2. EUR 9.99; 3. EUR 19.99; 4. EUR 29.99; 5. EUR 39.99; 6. EUR 49.99; 7. EUR 59.99.

Source: authors' research.

The data for the CBC study was collected during July and August 2023. The survey was designed through the Conjointly online platform. The platform constructs a choice experiment based on specified attributes and levels and its algorithm ensures minimum overlap and utility balance. Minimal overlap is achieved when alternatives in each choice set possess attribute levels that do not overlap. Whereas utility balance is attained when the utilities of alternatives within choice sets are equal (Zwerina et al., 1996).

The survey link was distributed through various channels including personal communication tools and various survey platforms to the consumers from different countries including Germany, England, United States and Türkiye. A total of 723 respondents approached the survey by opening the link, whereas 244 of them completed it. Online surveys offer valuable advantages in research due to the

researcher's ability to maintain rigorous methodological control over factors such as question sequencing, response completeness, and filtering, as opposed to these aspects being influenced by respondents. Additionally, online surveys not only provide rapid results but also enable the generation of real-time data (Evans et al., 2005).

Results and discussions. Table 2 provides a breakdown of the survey's demographic composition. Notable observations include a higher representation of females compared to males. Moreover, a significant majority, which constitutes 79.92 % of the participants hold bachelor's and master's degrees, emphasising a well-educated group. Interestingly, 31.56 % of participants report an annual income below EUR 20,000, which may be linked to the substantial number of students in the survey (37.30 %). Furthermore, a significant portion of respondents, namely 43.03 %, are employed full-time, predominantly constituting the non-student segment of the sample.

Table 2

Overview of respondent demographics

Demographic	Category	Total (N = 244)	%
Gender	Male	91	37.30
	Female	147	60.25
	Other	1	0.41
	Prefer not to say	5	2.05
Education	High school diploma or equivalent	35	14.34
	Bachelor's degree	125	51.23
	Master's degree	70	28.69
	Doctorate degree	10	4.10
	Prefer not to say	4	1.64
Annual income	Less than EUR 20,000	77	31.56
	EUR 20,000–40,000	31	12.70
	EUR 40,000–60,000	40	16.39
	EUR 60,000–80,000	22	9.02
	EUR 80,000– 00,000	21	8.61
	Over EUR 100,000	30	12.30
	Prefer not to say	23	9.43
Employment status	Employed full-time	105	43.03
	Employed part-time	27	11.07
	Self-employed	8	3.28
	Unemployed	7	2.87
	Student	91	37.3
	Retired	1	0.41
	Prefer not to say	5	2.05

Source: authors' calculations.

In the CBC study conducted, the objective is to examine and quantify the factors influencing sustainable clothing consumption. To answer the first research question aiming to discover the determining attributes of consumers' clothing preferences, relative attribute importance is calculated through the range of the partworth utilities and compared to determine the hierarchy of decision factors. The attribute importance

serves as an initial measure to identify the attribute that exerts the most significant influence on shaping respondents' choices (Eggers et al., 2021).

The decision to express relative attribute importance as percentages, rather than employing alternative scoring methods, was to improve the clarity and ease of interpretation of the study's results. Using percentages simplifies the communication of the study findings, allowing for direct and universal comparisons. By placing percentage-based importance of various attributes side by side as in Figure 1, it becomes easy to interpret which attributes hold greater influence and which are comparatively less important. The percentages of each attribute importance sum up to 100 %, reflecting that the entire decision-making process is covered and each attribute's importance is proportional to its role in consumers' choices. It is crucial to emphasise that within the analysis, a higher percentage explicitly signifies a greater level of significance for an attribute's influence on consumer choices.

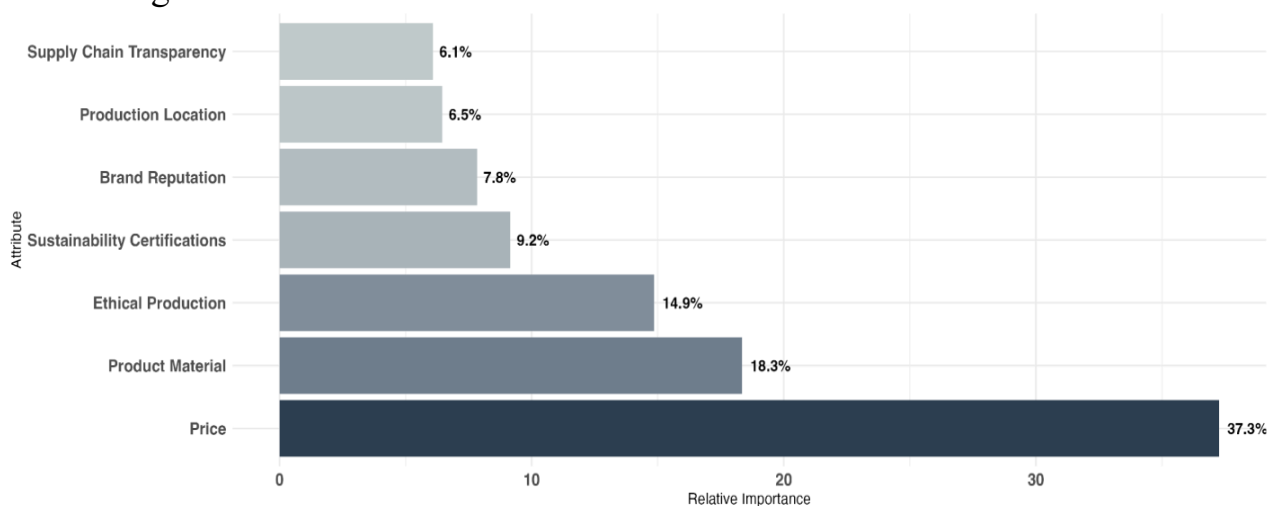


Figure 1. Relative attribute importances

Source: authors' research.

Figure 1 displays the relative importance of each attribute. The most salient finding is the dominance of price, commanding a substantial 37.3 % importance percentage. This underscores the economic consideration shaping sustainable clothing consumption choices, highlighting the delicate balance between affordability and sustainability from the respondents' standpoint. Following price, the product material is the second consideration that consumers prioritise, accounting for 18.3 % in relative attribute importance. The respondents substantially focus on the material quality and also the environmental impact of utilising these materials. Buying clothes manufactured under ethical labor conditions is also quite imperative for consumers, whereas ethical production practices received 14.9 % in relative attribute importance.

On the contrary, supply chain transparency emerges as the least influential, with a modest importance percentage of 6.1 %. This implies that compared to other attributes in the study, knowing the aspects of the clothing item's supply chain has a relatively minor impact on consumer choices in the context of sustainable fashion. Likewise, the geographical production location has a limited influence, contributing just 6.5 % to the overall decision-making process. Brand reputation is also ranked

among the less pivotal factors, accounting for a mere 7.8 %. Sustainability certificates hold a relatively lower importance percentage of 9.2 %, indicating that the presence of such labels on clothing products is not as decisive in shaping consumer choices as price, product material, and ethical production.

While relative importance reflects the overall importance of an attribute, relative preferences delve into specific levels within those attributes. They complement each other in understanding consumer decision-making. Therefore, before analysing the attribute level partworth utilities in great detail, the results of the CBC study are summarized in Table 3.

Table 3

Summary of CBC analysis results

Attribute	Levels of the attribute	Average partworth utilities	Relative importance of the attribute, %
Brand reputation	Established eco-friendly brand	0.26	7.82
	Emerging sustainable brand	0.03	
	Strong mass-market reputation	-0.29	
Product material	Sustainable material	1.31	18.36
	Non-sustainable material	-1.31	
Ethical production	Fair wages & safe working conditions	1.06	14.87
	No ethical production considerations	-1.06	
Sustainability certifications	No sustainability certificate available	-0.42	9.14
	Limited sustainability certification	-0.10	
	Moderate sustainability certification	0.19	
	Extensive sustainability certification	0.33	
Production location	Germany	0.28	6.45
	Europe	0.11	
	Overseas	-0.39	
Supply chain transparency	No supply chain information available	-0.29	6.08
	Limited supply chain information available	0.16	
	Detailed supply chain information available	0.13	
Price	EUR 5.99	1.89	37.28
	EUR 9.99	1.96	
	EUR 19.99	1.47	
	EUR 29.99	0.50	
	EUR 39.99	-0.79	
	EUR 49.99	-1.98	
	EUR 59.99	-3.05	

Source: authors' calculations.

The column "Average Partworth Utilities" represents the quantitative measure of consumer preferences for each attribute level, indicating the degree of desirability assigned by respondents to those levels. These utility values are derived by averaging individual preference scores for each attribute level and then calculating the deviation

from the overall average of level utility scores within the attribute, ensuring that the sum of partworth utilities across all levels is 0. As a result, to maintain the zero-sum utility constraint, each attribute's levels take both positive and negative utility values, signifying their relative desirability. Lower utility values suggest reduced preference for a level, while higher values imply a stronger aversion and negative values indicate a decrease in the overall value of the product.

To enhance visual clarity and promote a more intuitive understanding, partworth utility scores are converted into percentages. The transformation is accomplished by dividing the level-specific average by the overall utility range, which is determined as the cumulative sum of the range utility calculated from the average utility of each level across all attributes. The percentages are again 0-centered within each attribute as in the partworth utility scores. Figure 2 illustrates the distribution of attribute level partworth utility percentages, with each attribute level represented on the y-axis and color-coded according to their respective attribute ownership. While certain bar charts exhibit positive values and others show negative values, the levels collectively offset one another, resulting in a cumulative sum of zero.

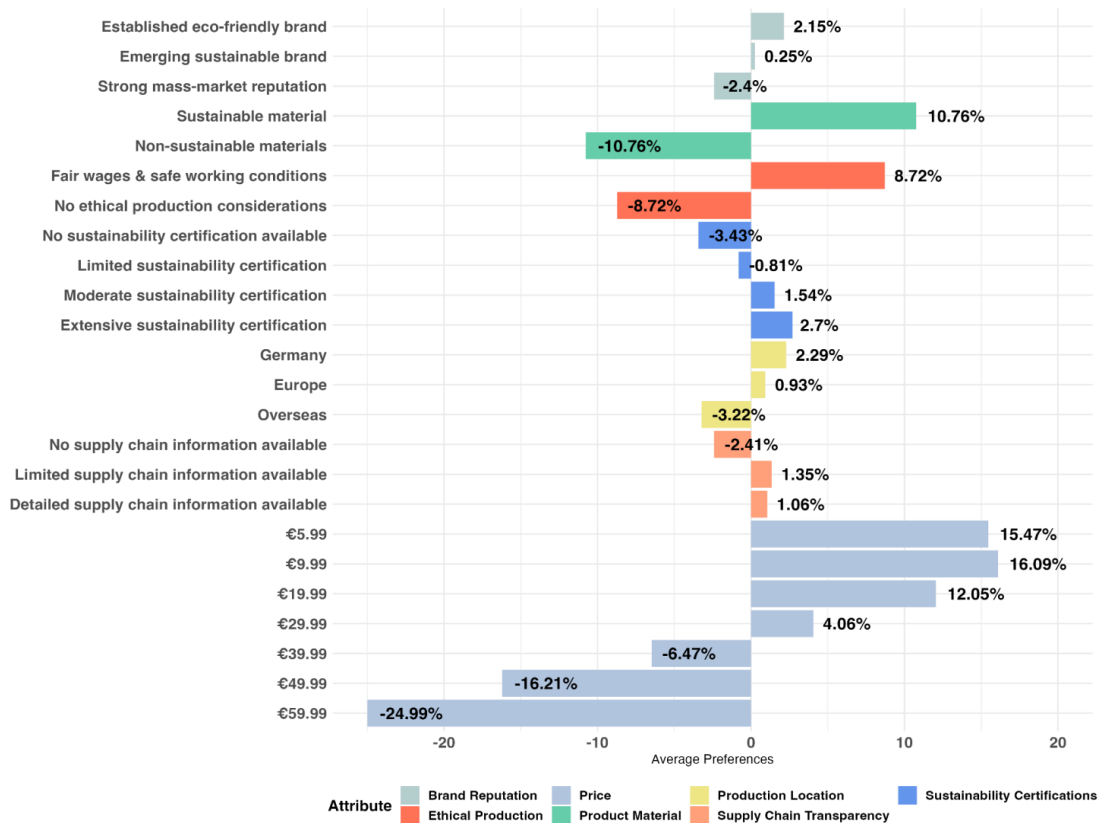


Figure 2. Attribute level partworth utilities

Source: authors' research.

Within the "Brand Reputation" attribute, respondents show a preference for established eco-friendly brands (2.2 %), meaning that they had a slight inclination to choose products from these brands compared to ones of an emerging sustainable brand (0.3 %). Products associated with a brand that has a strong mass-market reputation were notably less preferred, as respondents were 2.4 % less likely to choose them

compared to options favoring eco-friendliness and sustainability. The attribute “Product Material” exhibits a clear divergence between its two levels. Clothing items made from sustainable materials (10.8 %) were preferred by respondents, whereas non-sustainable materials (-10.8 %) were less favored, suggesting that respondents were less likely to select products made from materials that are not environmentally sustainable.

The respondents lean towards products that embrace ethical production practices. Specifically, there is an 8.7 % preference for products that emphasise fair wages and safe working conditions for laborers, as opposed to products with no ethical production considerations. Additionally, they displayed varying preferences related to sustainability certifications. They favored products bearing more robust sustainability credentials, demonstrating a 2.7 % preference for extensively certified products and 1.5 % for those with moderate certification. Conversely, there was a dispreference of -3.4 % for products lacking certification and -0.81 % for items with limited certification, indicating a reluctance toward products without robust sustainability verification. In terms of geographical location, clothing items produced in Germany (2.3 %) and Europe (0.9 %) were preferred by respondents, indicating a positive inclination towards products manufactured in these regions. Conversely, there was a relative aversion to products produced overseas, with a -3.2 % dispreference for items made abroad. Moreover, respondents preferred products with detailed (1.0 %) and limited supply chain information available (1.4 %), indicating a positive inclination towards items with some degree of supply chain visibility. Both options clearly outweighed the dispreference (-2.4 %) associated with products lacking any supply chain transparency.

Analysing how individuals alter their preferences in response to fluctuations in product pricing is a pivotal aspect of comprehending consumer behavior. Brands must grasp this concept since it has a direct impact on the formulation of pricing strategies and the optimization of revenue. Within a CBC study framework, the evaluation of price sensitivity involves examining how respondents modify their selections when confronted with diverse product configurations offered at different price levels. To analyse the relationship between price and choice, it is necessary to quantify how alterations in price levels impact the likelihood of a product being selected. This analysis entails calculating choice probabilities for each product concept at different price points.

Figure 3 specifically designed to examine the price attribute in greater depth, utilising a line plot to uncover details within the average partworth utilities of each level. The steepness or flatness of the curve serves as a crucial indicator of price sensitivity among respondents. This complements the existing bar charts in Figure 2, offering a more comprehensive view of its trends. The respondents displayed distinct preferences that emphasise the significance of price shaping their decisions. The curve appears relatively flat between the price points of EUR 5.99 and EUR 9.99. This indicates a lower degree of price sensitivity within this range, as price changes have only a modest impact on average preference. They favored options priced at EUR 9.99

(16.09 %) and EUR 5.99 (15.47 %), signifying an apparent preference towards these lower-priced choices. Interestingly, the preference for EUR 9.99 was slightly surpassing that of EUR 5.99. Nevertheless, with rising prices, the level of attraction decreased after that point. Products priced at EUR 19.99 (12.05 %) were also well-received though to a lesser extent. However, as the price surpasses EUR 19.99 and continues to rise, the curve takes a sharp downturn. Options priced at EUR 29.99 (4.06 %), EUR 39.99 (-6.47 %), EUR 49.99 (-16.21 %), and EUR 59.99 (-24.99 %) experienced decreasing levels of preference, suggesting a decreasing propensity to choose higher-priced products. This pronounced dip in preference demonstrates that as prices escalate further, consumers become highly sensitive to these higher price levels. The finding underscores the importance of balancing sustainable offerings with accessible pricing strategies to cater the customer preferences and enhance the adoption of eco-friendly fashion.

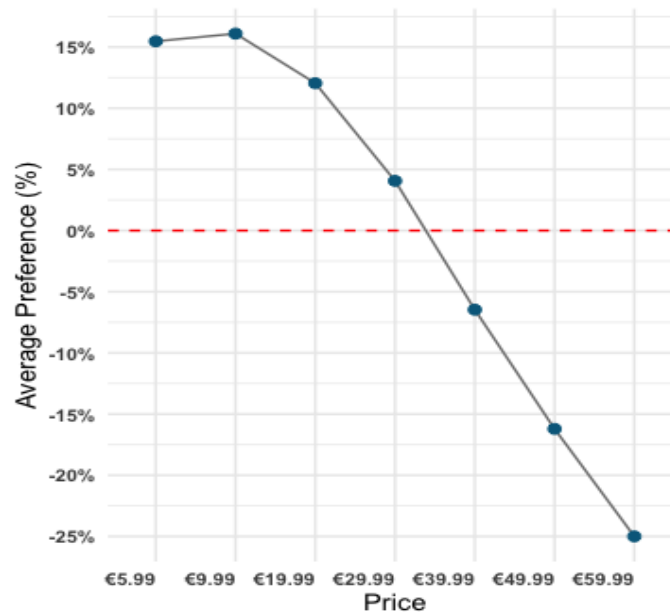


Figure 3. Average preferences for each price level

Source: authors' research.

After the estimation of the analysis results, the discussion centers on interpreting these findings in the context of the initial three research questions, illustrating the study's role in addressing these core inquiries. The determining attributes of consumers' clothing preferences have been elucidated through the analysis of the findings. Predominantly, price emerges as the most significant factor, indicating the substantial influence of economic considerations on sustainable clothing consumption choices. Following price, the choice of product material ranks second, reflecting the importance consumers place on material quality and the environmental impact of these materials. Ethical production practices, ranking as the third most important attribute, emphasise the critical role of ethical labor conditions in shaping the decision-making process of consumers. Brand reputation, while a factor, ranks among the third less pivotal considerations, while sustainability certificates, though relevant, do not hold the same decisive power as price, product material, and ethical production practices.

Supply chain transparency is the least influential attribute while geographical production location demonstrates a comparatively limited influence on consumer choices, suggesting that these attributes play a minor role in shaping preferences for sustainable fashion.

Based on the CBC analysis results on relative attribute importance, the pronounced significance of price, which surpasses the second most important attribute by more than twofold, highlights the strong conflict between affordability and sustainability from the respondents' viewpoint. Hence, it can be asserted that consumers accord a lower priority to sustainability factors in comparison to the price of the product. Nevertheless, respondents' evident interest in sustainable clothing materials should not be overlooked. The reason why product materials are so important in clothing choices could be that people associate sustainable materials such as cotton with the comfort of clothing. Following the set of conjoint questions, participants responded to additional inquiries regarding the determinants of their clothing purchase decisions. Significantly, the fit and comfort of a product emerged as a decisive factor for nearly all of them. Possibly, when participants were making choices among the conjoint questions, both nylon and conventional cotton exhibited unfavorable associations, commonly linked to discomfort in the minds of individuals. Even if environmental awareness may not be the main source of interest in sustainable garments, it is certain that people prioritise ethical production practices and whether a product is sustainability-certified or not.

Addressing the third research question can be facilitated by a comprehensive examination and comparison of the sociodemographic attributes. One group of respondents prioritises sustainable features in their clothing purchases, while the other places primary emphasis on the price of the product. Analysing these two distinct groups is crucial for understanding the impact of sociodemographic profiles on pro-sustainable behaviours in clothing acquisition. The proportion of females in the sustainable segment aligns with the overall distribution within the respondent pool, surpassing the representation of males. In contrast, the segment that prioritises budget considerations demonstrates a more even gender distribution. Interestingly, no relationship has been found between the respondents' education levels and their pro-environmental attitudes. On the other hand, the impact of annual income is quite significant, as individuals in higher income brackets are more prominent in the sustainable segment, exceeding the proportions in the price-focused segment to a great extent. The segment that places a premium on price demonstrates a marginally higher representation of students, with a smaller group involved in full-time and part-time employment. In contrast, individuals who prioritise the sustainable aspects of clothing predominantly occupy full-time employment positions. The sustainability-focused segment exhibits an older average age in comparison to the price-focused segment, an outcome that can be attributed to the higher prevalence of students in the latter group.

In summary, individuals with higher income levels tend to place less emphasis on a product's price when making clothing purchases, and they tend to prioritise

sustainable attributes. Among various employment status categories such as full-time and part-time employment, self-employment, unemployment, student status, and retirement, it is evident that higher income is primarily linked with full-time employment. Consequently, the segment that prioritises sustainable aspects consists of a larger number of non-students, accounting for the higher average age within this group compared to the overall respondent population. Thus, in light of the study's findings, it is reasonable to assert that a correlation exists between higher income and the propensity to make sustainable clothing choices. When individuals navigate the trade-off between environmental concerns and affordability, their budgetary considerations come into play. Furthermore, it's worth highlighting that no clear connection has been identified between individuals' educational levels and their inclination toward eco-friendly preferences.

Conclusions. The main objective of this study is to explore shifting consumer behaviours in the clothing industry, driven by a growing demand for sustainable alternatives. The exploration began with the recognition that people's clothing choices are no longer solely driven by price and fashion trends, but also by a profound commitment to environmental consciousness. This transformation not only reshapes the image of the market but also compels brands to rethink their offerings. The study aimed to address this change comprehensively.

The research questions were employed as guiding markers, providing a structured framework for the exploration of this landscape. The critical attributes that direct consumers in their clothing preferences were sought to be determined. Simultaneously, an effort was made to assess the degree to which sustainability is prioritised in their decision-making processes, along with the tradeoffs executed between various clothing attributes and sustainability factors. Further exploration was conducted to delve deeper into the impact of sociodemographic factors on eco-friendly orientation.

The CBC analysis results help to rank attributes influencing individuals' clothing choices, enabling brands to gain a deeper understanding of customer expectations. This understanding empowers brands to prioritise and deprioritise their efforts effectively, ensuring they align with what customers are seeking, ultimately enhancing brand relevance and customer satisfaction. Respondents highlight the significance of price as the most crucial factor, emphasising the delicate equilibrium between cost-effectiveness and sustainability. Additionally, the type of fabric used in clothing ranks as the second most influential element, with ethical production practices following closely behind. Sustainability certifications come in as the fourth most important factor, with brand reputation following in importance. On the other hand, supply chain transparency and the location of production have a relatively limited impact on consumer decision-making.

The study presents several noteworthy limitations, and it highlights opportunities for further research. Several limitations are associated with the inherent biases observed in the sample collection process. The research exclusively relies on an online survey, which inherently skews the participant pool toward a younger demographic

possessing internet accessibility. This demographic skew is further exacerbated by the distribution of the survey link through personal connections, primarily comprising a younger audience. Additionally, the online survey platforms utilized in this study cater predominantly to students who are incentivized to obtain respondents by completing other surveys, further narrowing the participant profile. When examining sample characteristics, this observation becomes particularly evident. The majority of respondents are students, leading to an imbalance in income dispersion. Hence, the study's findings cannot be readily generalized to the broader population but rather to a more homogenous cohort. Future research endeavors could address these limitations by employing a more representative population distribution in terms of income and employment status.

The CBC estimation could be broadened to incorporate predictive modeling, thereby resulting in a more profound comprehension of consumer preferences and market dynamics. An extended approach can forecast consumer preferences, thus enabling the estimation of market shares of different product bundles. This could facilitate comparative assessments between different prospective competitive offerings and potential new market entrants. Such an analysis also provides a robust framework for assessing how alterations in pricing strategies influence consumer choices. By comprehensively examining the price elasticity of the entire market and various consumer segments', it equips brands with the tools necessary to optimize their pricing strategies effectively. Furthermore, this research may offer valuable insights for diverse academic disciplines, particularly psychology. A potential avenue for further exploration could involve delving into consumer psychology through the lens of tradeoffs between sustainability and price. It may seek to uncover the disparities between the individuals' professed prioritization of integrating sustainable practices into their daily lives and the actual relative importance attributed to the price of products. Such an investigation could be facilitated through an in-depth analysis of the CBC study results, offering a perspective on the intricacies of consumer decision-making processes.

Moreover, certain aspects of the analysis remain unanswered, highlighting the need for further research. Expanding CBC estimation results and incorporating predictive analysis could yield a deeper understanding of consumer preferences under various simulated scenarios, allowing brands to estimate the potential market share of hypothetical products and develop new pricing strategies. Additionally, the study presents opportunities for further research in the field of psychology, particularly regarding the conflict between individuals' stated interest in sustainable living and their deprioritisation of sustainability when price becomes a factor, which represents an area of exploration in consumer psychology.

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